

HOUSE RESOLUTION 184

By Cepicky

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Edward Allen Hickman of Columbia.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Edward Allen Hickman; and

WHEREAS, Eddie Hickman was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on October 28, 1950, in Columbia, Mr. Hickman was the son of Athel and Evelyn Carpenter Hickman and grew up on Dimple Court alongside his sisters, Donna and Paula; and

WHEREAS, Eddie Hickman was a 1969 graduate of Columbia Central High School, where he excelled as a student athlete in both basketball and baseball; from an early age, he aspired to return to his alma mater to teach and coach; and

WHEREAS, after attending Columbia State Community College, Mr. Hickman graduated from David Lipscomb University in 1973; he began a lifelong career in education with the Maury County School System that same year; and

WHEREAS, over the course of his distinguished forty-two-year career, Eddie Hickman served with dedication and distinction at Hampshire Unit School, Mt. Pleasant High School, Whitthorne Junior High School, and Columbia Central High School, where he fulfilled his lifelong dream of teaching and coaching and ultimately served as assistant principal and principal; and

WHEREAS, in 2004, he was appointed to serve as Director of Schools for Maury County, a role in which he continued to demonstrate steadfast leadership and an unwavering commitment to the students, educators, and families of the community until his retirement in 2015; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hickman was the recipient of numerous honors throughout his distinguished career, including designation as a Tennessee Colonel Aide de Camp, the National High School Coaching Award, WOW Outstanding Citizen Award, A.F. Bridges Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association School System Administrator of the Year Award, Superintendent of the Year for the South-Central Region, recognition as a Paul Harris Fellow, TSSAA Administrator of the Year Award, and National Association of School Resource Officers Award, among many others; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as a coach, Eddie Hickman guided his basketball teams to appearances in the Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association substate and state tournaments; and

WHEREAS, he remained actively engaged in his community in retirement through his involvement with the Columbia Breakfast Rotary Club, the Tennessee School Resource Officer Board, COGINA-Advanced Ed, Maury County Retired Teachers Association, and EA Auctioneering Team; and

WHEREAS, a man of faith, Mr. Hickman was a longtime member of Beech Grove Church of Christ, where he served in a number of capacities; and

WHEREAS, Eddie Hickman found great joy in spending time with his family and working on his beloved farm, Mockingbird Hill, where he shared in the simple pleasures of farming, riding horses, and building lasting memories with his family; and

WHEREAS, he is survived by his loving wife of fifty-six years, Sheila Hutcherson Hickman; his daughter, Sarah Elizabeth (Sean) Hickman-McLeod; his granddaughter, Ellie Grace Hickman-McLeod; his sisters, Donna (Tommy) Briggs and Paula (Glenn) Brewer; several nieces and nephews; special nephew, Bert (Lori) Hutcherson; special niece, Haley (Derrick) Carroll; his schnauzers, Andy Dog and Sally Anne; and his horse, Red; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hickman leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of Edward Allen Hickman, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Hickman.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.